Aritra Basu

Department of Economics, University of Massachusetts Amherst
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Education

University of Massachusetts Amherst 2021–Present

Ph.D. candidate in Economics, expected 2027
Dissertation committee: James Heintz (Chair), Nancy Folbre, Christopher Boone, Joya Misra

University of Massachusetts Amherst 2023

M.A. in Economics

McGill University 2019–2021

Graduate coursework in Economics

Ambedkar University Delhi 2017–2019

M.A. in Economics

Jadavpur University 2013–2016

B.A. in Economics

Research Fields

Identity and Inequality; Labor Economics; Development Economics

Publications

Basu, Aritra, and Nancy Folbre. 2026. "Employment in Childcare and Early Education in the United States, 2000–23." *Monthly Labor Review*, July.
doi:10.21916/mlr.2026.19

Job Market Paper

"Crossing the Color Line: Race, Place, and Deaths of Despair."

Working Papers

"Before Love Jihad: Communal Violence and Religious Intermarriages in India."
Under review at *Feminist Economics*.

"Are All Low-Wage Workers Alike? Heterogeneity in the Post-Pandemic U.S. Labor Market."
With Caterina Manicardi and Anamika Sen.

Work in Progress

"Redirecting Intergroup Antagonism: Caste Networks, Hindu Nationalism, and the Evolution of Hate Crimes in India."
Dissertation chapter.

"What Money Can't Buy: Gender and Substitutability between Income and Unpaid Work in the U.S."
With Nancy Folbre.

Teaching Experience

Instructor, University of Massachusetts Amherst Fall 2026 (current)

ECON 337: Economics in the Age of Big Data

Instructor, University of Massachusetts Amherst Winter 2026

ECON 104: Introduction to Macroeconomics

Teaching Assistant, University of Massachusetts Amherst Sept. 2021–May 2022

- ECON 104: Introduction to Macroeconomics, Spring 2022.
- ECON 103: Introduction to Microeconomics, Fall 2021.

Research Experience

Research Assistant to Professor Nancy Folbre Sept. 2022–Summer 2026

Political Economy Research Institute, University of Massachusetts Amherst

Conference Presentations

"Revising Deaths of Despair: Racial Residential Segregation and the Unequal Toll of the China Shock."
John Jay–New School Conference on Contemporary Political Economy, New York, NY, February 27, 2026.

"Race Shocks: Manufacturing Declines and Residential Segregation."
ASSA Annual Meeting, Association for Social Economics session, Philadelphia, PA, January 3, 2026.

"Before Love Jihad: Communal Violence and Religious Intermarriages in India."
33rd IAFFE Annual Conference, University of Massachusetts Amherst, Amherst, MA, July 5, 2025.

"Law and Social Reproduction in Assam's Tea Plantations: 1859–1901."
50th Eastern Economic Association Annual Meeting, Boston, MA, March 1, 2024.

"Law and Social Reproduction in Assam's Tea Plantations: 1859–1901."
John Jay College, Law and Political Economy, New York, NY, 2023.

Referee Service

Feminist Economics; *American Sociological Review.*

Awards and Fellowships

PERI Barnard Family Fellowship 2025

Political Economy Research Institute, University of Massachusetts Amherst

Academic Merit Scholarships 2017–2019

Ambedkar University Delhi

- M.A. Fall and Winter semesters, 2018–2019.
- M.A. Fall and Winter semesters, 2017–2018.

Silver Medal for Ranking Second in B.A. 2016

Jadavpur University

Technical Skills

Stata (proficient); R (proficient).

Languages

Bengali (native); Hindi (fluent); English (fluent).

References

James Heintz
Department of Economics, University of Massachusetts Amherst
jheintz@econs.umass.edu

Nancy Folbre
Department of Economics, University of Massachusetts Amherst
nancy.folbre@gmail.com

Christopher Boone
Department of Economics, University of Massachusetts Amherst
cboone@umass.edu